CLINICAL EDUCATION RESOURCE PACKET

Nursing Assessment Academy

Clinical References and Content Review Overview

Prepared by	MedSkillBuilder LLC
Resource	Nursing Assessment Academy - 8 modules plus capstone
Evidence review	Completed September 4, 2026
Clinical review status	Independent credentialed nursing review pending

Purpose of this packet

This packet responds to questions about the clinical development, evidence base, review status, update process, and bibliography for the MedSkillBuilder Nursing Assessment Academy. It is intended to support evaluation of the Academy as a supplemental educational resource.

Scope statement. The Academy supports learning and clinical reasoning. It does not provide medical advice, establish a standard of care, replace organizational policy or supervised skills validation, or certify bedside competency.

Responses to clinical-content questions

1. What references and professional guidance support the content?

Content is mapped to government, professional-organization, and federally hosted clinical resources. Principal sources include NCSBN clinical-judgment guidance; CDC infection-prevention and fall-prevention resources; FDA pulse-oximetry information; AHRQ TeamSTEPPS communication guidance; American Heart Association and American Stroke Association resources; KDIGO kidney guidance; NPIAP pressure-injury resources; and Open RN/NCBI Bookshelf assessment references.

2. Who develops and clinically reviews the content?

The lessons, scenarios, questions, and explanations are developed internally by MedSkillBuilder. A structured evidence-alignment review against the sources in this packet was completed on September 4, 2026, and identified safeguards that were incorporated into the Academy. An independent review by a credentialed RN has not yet been completed; therefore, MedSkillBuilder does not claim independent RN validation, institutional approval, or clinical endorsement.

3. What is the documented content-review date?

The evidence-alignment review documented in this packet was completed on September 4, 2026. This date identifies that completed review; it does not indicate independent nursing validation.

4. Is a bibliography available?

Yes. The module-by-module source map begins on the following page. The master bibliography provides source details and direct links for verification.

5. How can a content concern be reported?

Questions, source concerns, and suggested corrections can be submitted through the MedSkillBuilder contact page. Include the module, lesson or question, the concern, and any relevant supporting reference.

Contact: https://medskillbuilder.com/contact.html

Copyright and attribution approach

The Academy uses original MedSkillBuilder instructional wording. External standards and resources are identified by organization, title, and link for attribution and verification rather than reproduced as substantial copied text, images, charts, or logos. Cited organizations are not represented as sponsors, approvers, or endorsers of MedSkillBuilder.

Module-by-module source map

Reference IDs correspond to the master bibliography. Some sources support more than one module because foundational assessment, safety, and communication principles apply across the Academy.

Module 1: Assessment Foundations

Content scope: Baseline; subjective/objective data; comprehensive vs. focused assessment; system-specific sequence; reassessment and escalation.

Mapped references: R1, R2, R3, R4, R5

Module 2: Vital Signs, Pain & General Survey

Content scope: Vital-sign trends; appearance and work of breathing; multidimensional pain assessment; validation of conflicting monitor data; subtle deterioration.

Mapped references: R5, R7, R8, R9, R10, R17, R24

Module 3: Neurological Assessment

Content scope: Baseline mental status; pupils; strength, pronator drift and symmetry; GCS components/trends; stroke red flags and urgent escalation.

Mapped references: R11, R12, R13, R14, R15

Module 4: Respiratory Assessment

Content scope: Work of breathing; pulse-oximetry limitations; systematic lung-sound comparison; contextual interpretation; fatigue and impending failure.

Mapped references: R16, R17, R18, R19, R20

Module 5: Cardiovascular & Peripheral Vascular

Content scope: Perfusion patterns; pulse/extremity comparison; edema description; heart-sound context; orthostatic symptoms and safety.

Mapped references: R8, R21, R22, R23, R24

Module 6: Abdominal, GI & GU Assessment

Content scope: Inspection; abdominal exam order; gentle palpation; rigidity/tenderness red flags; urine-output trends and catheter-system troubleshooting.

Mapped references: R4, R25, R26, R27

Module 7: Skin, Wounds & Musculoskeletal

Content scope: Skin assessment; dynamic pressure-injury risk; objective wound description; neurovascular checks; mobility and fall-risk reassessment; device pressure.

Mapped references: R28, R29, R30, R31, R32

Module 8: Head-to-Toe Clinical Judgment

Content scope: Prioritization; cue clustering; reassessment of highest-risk problem; communication; stopping routine assessment for immediate threats.

Mapped references: R1, R5, R6, R19, R33, R34, R35

Final Clinical Assessment Capstone

The capstone draws from all eight module bibliographies. Its clinical-judgment, prioritization, emergency-response, and structured-communication framework is additionally supported by R1, R5, R6, R19, R33, R34, and R35. The 85% threshold is identified as a course passing score, not proof of clinical competency.

Master bibliography

Links are provided for verification. Source dates reflect the versions reviewed for the September 4, 2026 evidence-alignment assessment.

R1. National Council of State Boards of Nursing (NCSBN). Clinical Judgment Measurement Model: A Framework to Measure Clinical Judgment and Decision Making. (Current web resource). Source link

R2. Ernstmeyer, K., & Christman, E. (eds.). Open Resources for Nursing (Open RN). Nursing Fundamentals, Chapter 4: Nursing Process. (2021). Source link

R3. Toney-Butler, T. J., & Thayer, J. M. Nursing Process. StatPearls, NCBI Bookshelf. (Updated 2023). Source link

R4. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. Standard Precautions for All Patient Care. (2024). Source link

R5. The Joint Commission. National Performance Goals effective January 2026 for the Hospital Program. (2026). Source link

R6. Agency for Healthcare Research and Quality. TeamSTEPPS 3.0: Tool—SBAR. (Reviewed 2023). Source link

R7. Ernstmeyer, K., & Christman, E. (eds.). Open RN. Nursing Skills, Chapter 1: General Survey. (2021). Source link

R8. American Heart Association. Orthostatic Hypotension in Adults With Hypertension: Scientific Statement summary. (2024). Source link

R9. The Joint Commission. Pain Assessment and Management Standards for Critical Access Hospitals. (2018; effective 2019). Source link

R10. National Heart, Lung, and Blood Institute. What Is a Heart Attack? (2022). Source link

R11. American Stroke Association. Stroke Symptoms and Warning Signs. (Current web resource). Source link

R12. Glasgow Coma Scale. What is the Glasgow Coma Scale? (Current web resource). Source link

R13. Glasgow Coma Scale. Recording the Glasgow Coma Scale. (Current web resource). Source link

R14. Sánchez, J. C., et al. Neurologic Exam. StatPearls, NCBI Bookshelf. (Updated 2025). Source link

R15. Ernstmeyer, K., & Christman, E. (eds.). Open RN. Nursing Skills, Chapter 6: Neurological Assessment. (2021). Source link

R16. Ernstmeyer, K., & Christman, E. (eds.). Open RN. Nursing Skills, Chapter 10: Respiratory Assessment. (2021). Source link

R17. U.S. Food and Drug Administration. Pulse Oximeter Basics. (2025). Source link

R18. U.S. Food and Drug Administration. Pulse Oximeters. (2025). Source link

R19. American Heart Association. 2025 Guidelines for CPR and ECC, Part 7: Adult Basic Life Support. (2025). Source link

R20. Ernstmeyer, K., & Christman, E. (eds.). Open RN. Nursing Fundamentals, Chapter 8: Oxygenation. (2021). Source link

R21. Ernstmeyer, K., & Christman, E. (eds.). Open RN. Nursing Skills, Chapter 9: Cardiovascular Assessment. (2021). Source link

R22. Gornik, H. L., et al. 2024 ACC/AHA Multisociety Guideline for the Management of Lower Extremity Peripheral Artery Disease. (2024). Source link

R23. American Heart Association. Heart Failure Signs and Symptoms. (Reviewed 2025). Source link

R24. American Heart Association. 2025 High Blood Pressure Guideline. (2025). Source link

R25. Ferguson, C. M. In Walker, H. K., Hall, W. D., & Hurst, J. W. (eds.). Inspection, Auscultation, Palpation, and Percussion of the Abdomen. Clinical Methods, 3rd ed. (1990; foundational examination reference). Source link

R26. Kidney Disease: Improving Global Outcomes (KDIGO). Clinical Practice Guideline for Acute Kidney Injury. (2012; update in development). Source link

R27. Toney-Butler, T. J., & Unison-Pace, W. J. Nursing Admission Assessment and Examination. StatPearls, NCBI Bookshelf. (Updated 2023). Source link

R28. National Pressure Injury Advisory Panel. International Guidelines. (Current resource hub). Source link

R29. National Pressure Injury Advisory Panel. Medical Device–Related Pressure Injury resources. (Current resource). Source link

R30. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. STEADI: Clinical Resources. (2025). Source link

R31. Ernstmeyer, K., & Christman, E. (eds.). Open RN. Nursing Skills, Chapter 13: Musculoskeletal Assessment. (2021). Source link

R32. Althoff, A. D., et al. Splinting. StatPearls, NCBI Bookshelf. (Updated 2023). Source link

R33. Agency for Healthcare Research and Quality. TeamSTEPPS 3.0. (Updated 2023). Source link

R34. American Heart Association. 2025 Guidelines for CPR and ECC, Part 4: Systems of Care. (2025). Source link

R35. Ernstmeyer, K., & Christman, E. (eds.). Open RN. Nursing Fundamentals: Nursing Process and the NCSBN Clinical Judgment Measurement Model. (2024). Source link

Review limitations and appropriate use

- This packet documents evidence alignment; it is not accreditation, continuing-education approval, psychometric validation, or an independent clinical endorsement.
- Institutional adopters should evaluate the Academy against their patient population, setting, policies, equipment, documentation requirements, emergency procedures, and staff scope of practice.
- Learners must follow applicable orders, local policy, infection-prevention requirements, and emergency-response procedures.
- Independent credentialed nursing review remains pending and will be identified by reviewer name, credentials, scope, and date only if completed and authorized for disclosure.

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